does not attribute to the Israeli side any act intended to force or encourage the Arabs to flee, although almost every day during this period there were clashes between the two populations in the mixed cities, as well as along roads and in agricultural areas.

The second phase took place from April to June 1948. During this period, another three hundred thousand Arabs left, fled, or were expelled. The component of expulsion, though not a policy determined by the Israelis, was the result of the conviction that an invasion by the Arab states' regular armies would take place immediately upon the termination of the Mandate on May 15, 1948, and that until that time everything must be done to prevent the formation of a "fifth column" who would fight alongside them. Neither "Plan D" (see below) nor any other document included an explicit deportation order, either from the territories of the State of Israel according to the Partition Plan or from other territories. However, there was a general understanding that the smaller the number of Arabs in the Jewish state, the better, and "Plan D" left the discretion regarding this matter in the hands of the brigade commanders.

The Arab Higher Committee, in anticipation of the invasion of the Arab armies, urged Arab residents to evacuate women, children, and the elderly from their places of residence. Their encouragement had results on the ground, with many Arabs responding to their call. Thus the Mufti al-Husseini contributed significantly to the mass flight of the Arabs.

The third phase occurred from June to September 1948. During this period, the Israeli government made a strategic decision not to allow the refugees to return to their places of residence. This was a correct and appropriate decision that ensured the survival of the State of Israel (a view also shared by Benny Morris). During the "Battles of the Ten Days" in mid-July 1948, Israeli forces raided Lod, Ramle, and Nazareth. About fifty thousand Arabs were expelled from Lod and Ramle (the largest expulsion of the war). The reason for this was that these two cities blocked the passage from Tel Aviv to the east and were at the rear of Latrun, where Arab control was the main obstacle to the liberation of the road to Jerusalem. In contrast to Lod and Ramle, where orders were issued to expel the residents, no such command was issued in Nazareth. There the residents who did not flee remained in their homes and continued to live in the city even after its occupation by the Israelis.